SESSION 1 OF 6 · 3 HOURS

Beyond Ad Hoc Prompting

Principles of Structured Prompt Design

MSc in AI and Digital Strategy Management

Advanced Prompting & API Integration



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Session roadmap

Time	Block	Format
0:00	Welcome, course arc, why structure matters	Briefing
0:20	Anatomy of an effective prompt	Briefing + live demo
0:50	Workshop 1: rewrite a weak prompt	Pairs
1:25	Break (10 min)	—
1:35	Common mistakes and quick iteration	Briefing + discussion
2:00	Workshop 2: compare and evaluate outputs	Groups of 3–4
2:35	Workflow project brief and wrap-up	Plenary

Contact details and resources



fabien.gueret-jullien@bsb-education.com

https://www.linkedin.com/in/fgueret/

https://github.com/fabiengueret21/BSB-Advance-Prompting-API-integration

Claude.ai

VS Code / Python

Anatomy of an effective prompt

01

Role

Sets expertise and perspective

Act as a senior HR business partner

02

Context

Supplies purpose and audience

For a 40-person retailer launching hybrid work

03

Task

States the core intent

Draft a one-page announcement email

04

Constraints

Bounds tone, length and rules

Max 150 words, warm, no jargon

05

Output format

Shapes the structure

Subject line, three bullets, one call to action



One task, two prompts



AD HOC

“Write an email about our new policy.”

Typical result: generic tone, unclear audience, length left to chance

STRUCTURED

“Act as a senior HR business partner. Draft an announcement email on our new hybrid-work policy for a 40-person retailer. Max 150 words, warm but professional. Format: subject line, three bullets, one call to action.”

Typical result: targeted, consistent and reusable across similar tasks

Role, audience and tone



Role

Domain-specific reasoning and vocabulary

Act as a cybersecurity analyst

Audience context

Depth and level of complexity

Assume the reader has no technical background

Tone

Voice and emotional register

Concise and professional

Role + tone

Tailored, professional-sounding result

Instructional designer, informative yet approachable



Common prompting mistakes

Mistake	Typical symptom	Fix
Vague request	Generic, unfocused output	Name the criterion: clarity, tone, concision
Missing context	Wrong audience or level	State the purpose and the reader
Overloaded prompt	Partial or skipped tasks	One task per prompt, or split into steps
No output format	Inconsistent layouts	Specify table, bullets, length
No success criteria	Quality cannot be judged	Define 3 checks before running

WORKSHOP 1 · 35 MIN · PAIRS

Rewrite a weak prompt

1. Pick a weak prompt, or bring your own · 5 min
2. Run it and save the output · 5 min
3. Rewrite with role, context, task, constraints, format · 10 min
4. Run both versions and compare side by side · 10 min
5. Share one insight with the class · 5 min

Deliverable: a before/after pair with three observed differences



WORKSHOP 2 · 35 MIN · GROUPS OF 3–4

Compare and evaluate outputs



Criterion	Score 1–5: guiding question
Relevance	Does it address the real business need?
Accuracy	Is anything invented or wrong?
Format adherence	Does it follow the requested structure?
Tone and audience	Would the target reader accept it?
Reusability	Would it work again with new inputs?

Swap prompts, rerun them, score blind, then agree on the one change that mattered most.

Workflow project brief

Choose a real, repeatable business task that your workflow will improve.

- Clear input and a measurable output
- Done often enough to be worth automating
- Uses public or non-sensitive data
- Suited to prompting now, API calls later

1 Prompt design	2 Prompt chains	3 API basics	4 Multi-step workflow	5 Optimize	6 Demo

Before Session 2: select the business task for your workflow project.

Further reading

- White et al. (2023), A Prompt Pattern Catalog to Enhance Prompt Engineering with ChatGPT
- Liu et al. (2023), Pre-train, Prompt, and Predict, ACM Computing Surveys
- Ekin (2023), Prompt Engineering for ChatGPT: A Quick Guide
- Mollick, One Useful Thing (newsletter), selected essays
- Official prompting documentation from your AI provider

Next session: few-shot examples, prompt chains and quality criteria.

